



to rely on the World Rankings in May to have an outside chance of qualification.

However, the team rankings are determined based on the individual player rankings. Harmeet Desai, ranked in the 60s, is India's highest-ranked paddler for now, having overtaken Sharath and G. Sathyan. The Tamil Nadu duo slipped beyond the top 100 due to a prolonged break at the start of the year and a dip in form later on. They managed to climb back to the 90s but still need to improve their rankings to qualify for singles. Instead, if the team qualifies, it will result in three men's quotas, including two singles spots, being sealed. While the paddlers continue to hone their game, the onus will be on the Table Tennis Federation of India (TTFI) to appoint full-time head coaches for both the men's and

Mukherjee Mania: Ayhika Mukherjee and Sutirtha Mukherjee stunned China's world No 2 pair to win a historic women's doubles table tennis medal for India at the last Asian Games. PTI

women's squads to provide the best possible support to the experienced players. Subhajit Saha, Sourav Chakravarty (men), and Mamata Prabhu (women) have done a commendable job whenever handed the responsibility to guide the teams in 2023. But with no proper contract and no control as a result, they had limitations when it came to working on a per-assignment basis.

The domestic circuit must also be streamlined further. After a tumultuous couple of years in the aftermath of the Tokyo debacle, dominated by a court-appointed Committee of Administrators, the



Highlights of 2023

Women

Sutirtha Mukherjee & Ayhika Mukherjee win a historic women's doubles bronze in Asian Games.

Manika Batra reaches the singles quarterfinals of the Asian Games. No Indian player has reached this far.

Men

Harmeet Desai upsets World No. 12 Jang Woojin of Korea in WTT Lagos and then puts it across Korea's Lim Jongoon WTT Contender in Tunis.

Indian men's team won bronze in Asian men's championships in Pyeongchang, South Korea.